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City transportation planner killed on bike

Woman who helped guide Bluebike policy hit by truck on Tremont Street

By Shannon Larson and Niki Griswold
GLOBE STAFF
and Bryan Hecht
GLOBE CORRESPONDENT

Louisa Gag was an enthusiastic cyclist, regularly riding the winding streets of Boston. Her passion extended to her professional life, where she worked in City Hall as a

bike-share and transportation planner to improve safety and accessibility on those very same roadways.

On Thursday morning, Gag was riding near Roxbury Crossing, an area known for its heavy and high-speed traffic, when she was fatally struck by the driver of a truck on Tremont Street, authorities said.

The crash sent shockwaves

through the cycling community, where advocates recalled her effusive joy and wide-ranging impact. And it also hit close to home in City Hall, where Gag had been an intern for Mayor Michelle Wu when she was a city counselor.

Wu said the 36-year-old will be remembered as a “bright light” and “dedicated public servant.”

“Our hearts are with her family, friends, colleagues, and all whose lives she touched,” Wu said in a statement. “I am absolutely devas-

tated by this unfathomable loss for our community and our city.”

Gag began working for Wu as a policy fellow when the latter was a city counselor and quickly became a “trusted colleague and partner,” the mayor recalled in her statement. She led programs and improvements that “made our streets safer, our communities stronger, and our residents’ daily lives better,” Wu said. “Her legacy will endure in the work she advanced across the city,

CYCLIST, Page A6

Unsettled Democrats in Maine press on

Platner’s departure leaves behind anger, confusion

By Sam Brodey, James Pindell, and Sabrina Shankman
GLOBE STAFF

ELLSWORTH, Maine — For so many Democrats across Maine, seemingly every hour since late Monday afternoon has carried waves of intense emotion.

Heartbreak, anger, regret, validation, confusion — all felt, sometimes several of them simultaneously, since the dramatic collapse of Senate hopeful Graham Platner.

That seismic development, set into motion this week by a Politico story Monday afternoon in which a former girlfriend accused Platner of rape, has reshaped Maine’s nationally watched Senate contest in the most direct way possible. Maine Democrats must now put forward a new nominee to challenge Republican Senator Susan Collins.

But the debacle could disrupt the race on a more fundamental level. In interviews with nearly a dozen Maine Democrats, from high-level officials to regular voters, it’s clear the emotions stirred by the Platner saga will linger for some time, and will even define how quickly the party can move forward.

Since launching his campaign last year, Platner, a first-time candidate, improbably built perhaps the most impressive grassroots campaign move-

PLATNER, Page A7



BARRY CHIN/GLOBE STAFF

Forward Kylian Mbappé celebrated after scoring a goal for France Thursday in Foxborough. Game details, C1.

World Cup: half full, half empty?

Foxborough residents reflect on Krafts and lessons from tournament

By Danny McDonald
GLOBE STAFF

FOXBOROUGH — It’s game day, and like he has for the past 37 years, Cal Davis is waiting for you to drive onto his lawn and pay cash for the privilege.

His house is situated a little more than 1 mile from where, in a few hours time, tens of thousands of fans would take in the last local game of this World Cup.

A 70-year-old semi-retired cabinetmaker, Davis operates a private parking lot at his North Street home. Just past noon-time Thursday, about a half-dozen cars had parked in his yard at \$100 each, and he was waiting for more fans to show up.

Like everyone else in this neighborhood, he has thoughts about the nearby Gillette Stadium and its owners, about the hassles and quirks of game days and concerts and general revel-



JESSICA RINALDI/GLOBE STAFF

Morocco fan Mohamed Boukhmis watched the World Cup quarterfinal match between Morocco and France inside Beirut Espresso in Revere. France won, 2-0. B1.

ry the stadium brings. Davis had expected the worst from this World Cup, namely, unimaginable traffic congestion, but he’s been impressed with how smoothly things have gone. Trains to the stadium have worked well. Fans have also

planned ahead of time, booking large vans or buses to Gillette or thereabouts.

For Davis it shows the region can take big events in stride.

“I really hope it opens it up for a possible Super Bowl here,” he said.

In this part of town, large-scale events are an accepted part of life. Locals know to avoid nearby Route 1 when Gil-

► **Boston ended its run as a host city for the 2026 World Cup on Thursday. B1.**

lette is packed. They take back roads, many of which are closed to all but local residents. Checkpoints on residential side streets are staffed by police officers, sheriff’s deputies, sometimes even public works employees, to prevent randos from parking wherever they please.

The relationship between the town, its residents, and the stadium and its ownership, which is spearheaded by Robert Kraft, can be a complicated one.

Indeed, Foxborough and Kraft are currently embroiled in legal fight over public safety costs associated with events at

FOXBOROUGH, Page A5

The race for Suffolk DA packs a punch

3-way contest gets testy as candidates seek an edge

By Sean Cotter
GLOBE STAFF

In politics, money talks. And in a three-way Suffolk district attorney’s race that’s heating up ahead of a winner-take-all September vote, it tells a tale of a complex three-way confrontation shaped by local controversy and individual personality.

The incumbent, Kevin Hayden, has raised the most money, with donations coming from familiar names in Boston’s political and legal circles. A lesser-known challenger, Linda Champion, has capitalized on Hayden’s recent controversial move to charge a Boston police officer after a shooting to lure new supporters and donations to her campaign; she even raised more than Hayden in the month she entered the race, though her fund-raising has since tailed off.

And then there’s Rachael Rollins, the former district attorney who resigned from her subsequent job as US attorney amid scandal three years ago. While she’s garnered significant coverage, apparently Rollins has barely raised any money yet.

A three-way race, each candidate with a story to tell.

“They’ve already shown us who they are; we

SUFFOLK, Page A6



Close to you

President Trump’s plans to build a skyline-altering arch in the nation’s capital won initial approval from a key federal commission. **A2.**

Governor Maura Healey signed, with no changes, a \$63 billion state budget plan that Massachusetts officials said does not raise taxes. **B1.**

The streaking Red Sox took their sixth straight, all on the road, this time sweeping the White Sox. **C1.**

Authentication codes factor in to our stress

BETH TEITELL
COMMENTARY

How hard can it be to grab your phone, retrieve a six-digit code, and type it in — seemingly the simplest task in the world — to avoid, oh, having your bank account emptied, your identity stolen, or yourself rendered a kind of stateless person, adrift without access to your own life?

Don’t get Thomas Lee, a Brigham and Women’s Hospital physician, started. “Two-factor authentication is sapping my will to live,” he said.

Or litigator Kara Thorvaldsen. “It’s the bane of my existence,” she said. “Every time

my husband tries to log into NESN, it somehow requires me to get a code and unlock something with Face ID, etc., etc., ad nauseam.”

Or Kim Smith, a playwright, an actor, and an empty nester. “Sometimes the only reason I hear from my [youngest] daughter is when she needs the code that’s been sent to my phone,” she said.

Or, or, or. As two-factor — or, even worse, multifactor — authentication becomes inescapable, it’s safe to say that somewhere in America, a spouse is shouting from another room, “Did you get my code?” An employee can’t get into his work plat-

MULTIFACTORS, Page A5

LOCKED OUT



MARIN WOLF/GLOBE STAFF

Nurses were turned away on Thursday morning when they tried to report to work at Brigham and Women’s Hospital after their strike on Wednesday. The hospital said its contract with the temporary nurses it had to hire requires at least five days of work. **B5.**

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